Working with Fabian

Team help: news articles and website updates

For a Brighter Evanston • Team guide

Use Slack to request changes; you do not need to edit code or use GitHub. This guide summarizes the repository's operating manuals, not a certification that every deployment setting or automation is active. The manuals linked at the end are the detailed source of truth.[1][2]

Start using it now

Post regular messages directly in the relevant Slack channel and mention @fabian, including follow-up confirmations. Do not use threads or the built-in `/help` command.[1][2]

- **Get the guide:** DM `-help`, or post `@fabian -help` in a channel.
- **Add news — #news:** `@fabian Add this article: [link]`. Review the English/Spanish titles and summaries plus source and publication date; then the requester or German replies `@fabian Yes, publish [article title]`.[1]
- **Remove news — #news:** `@fabian Remove [article title or link]`. Check the exact match, then the requester or German replies `@fabian Yes, remove [article title]`.[1]
- **Start website work — #website:** `@fabian Start a website update: [describe the change]`. If a sandbox is already open, the change joins that sandbox; nothing goes live yet.[2]
- **Build a page from a mockup — #website:** `@fabian Build this page from the attached mockup.` Fabian copies its text exactly and asks you for anything missing, like a `[day of the event]`.[2]
- **Request the review and vote — #website:** `@fabian Publish [sandbox name]`. Fabian reviews first, then opens a fresh vote with page links and a clear change summary. Asking to publish is not itself a vote.[2]
- **Vote — #website:** `@fabian vote yes`, `@fabian vote no: [reason]`, or `@fabian withdraw my vote`. Only messages after the vote opens and before its deadline count; two yes and no no votes permit publication.[2]
- **Restart voting:** if a vote is still active, say `@fabian cancel the vote`, then `@fabian Publish [sandbox name]`. An already cancelled or expired vote needs a fresh review and vote; old approvals do not carry forward.[2]

For every new request, Fabian reads the current operating manual rather than relying on an older conversation. Reaction-reading capability is never a prerequisite for message-based voting.[2]

Quick start

- **Get this guide:** send **`-help`** to Fabian. The latest PDF is kept in the GitHub repository at `docs/help/team-help.pdf`. This is a regular message, not the built-in `/help` command.
- **Add or remove a news article:** post in **#news**, mention **@fabian**, and wait for a preview. The requester or German must explicitly confirm before the change is published.[1]
- **Change website content:** post in **#website**, mention **@fabian**, and review the sandbox. Publication requires a review followed by **at least two yes votes and no no votes**, cast as messages to @fabian.[2]

- **Use top-level messages, never threads.** Keep follow-up answers and confirmations in the relevant channel and identify the article or sandbox when there could be confusion.[1][2]

1. Add or remove news articles

Add an article

Example request in #news

> @fabian Please add this article to In the news: [paste the article's link]

1. **Send the original article link.** Coverage should concern District 65—for example closures, finances, boundaries, childcare, early-childhood programs, board decisions or community responses.[1]

2. **Look for an acknowledgment.** Fabian should respond immediately, check whether the article is already listed, and read the source before preparing the preview.[1]

3. **Review the full preview.** It should show the original headline, an English summary, a Spanish title and summary, the outlet, publication date and article link. Any missing Spanish text or limitations in what Fabian could read should be disclosed.[1]

4. **Request corrections or approve.** For example: "Please change the summary to..." or "@fabian Yes, publish the RoundTable article about Dewey TWI." A changed preview requires a fresh confirmation. Only the requester or German can confirm; silence is not approval.[1]

5. **Wait for the live confirmation.** After approval, Fabian validates and uploads the entry, checks that it appears on the live site, then posts the English and Spanish page links. Each article is handled separately.[1]

Publication dates matter. Fabian must take the original publication date from the article's own dateline or publication metadata, in the outlet's local time—not an update date, URL, search result or today's date. If the date is unreadable or conflicting, Fabian asks you and waits. A date you provide is identified as user-provided; the full preview still needs approval.[1]

Blocked or paywalled article? Fabian may ask for the headline, publication date, another legal link or a summary you supply. If there is not enough content to summarize fairly, you may choose headline-only, provide a summary or skip the article. A duplicate will not be added again.[1]

Remove an article

Example requests in #news

> @fabian Remove the article titled "[full or partial title]."
>
> @fabian Remove the WTTW article published on [date].
>
> @fabian Remove this article from In the news: [link]

1. **Identify the article** by link, title, or outlet and date; include a reason if useful.[1]

2. **Check Fabian's match.** Fabian shows its full title, summary, source, date and link. If several articles match, choose the intended one; Fabian must still obtain explicit approval of the exact removal.[1]

3. **Confirm in #news.** For example: "@fabian Yes, remove [article title]." The requester or German must approve before removal.[1]

4. **Wait for verification.** Fabian removes the entry from both language versions and confirms after checking the live news list.[1]

To stop a pending addition or removal, say “cancel” or “stop.” To restore a removed article, request it in #news; restoring it requires an addition preview and confirmation.[1]

2. Request a website update

A clear channel for the whole team. Every website message should be brief and have a purpose: your request, preview links, understandable review findings, votes or results. Routine checks, technical details, internal learning notices and run-redirection tips stay behind the scenes. Brief “still working” updates remain, and Fabian should clearly explain any blocker or decision that needs your attention. Replies stay in the main channel, never in threads.

Start or join a sandbox

Example request in #website

> @fabian I want to update the website. Please add an FAQ page using the text below, and offer a Spanish version. [paste text]

1. **Describe the change clearly.** Include the existing page link, the exact replacement text or desired outcome, and any images or PDFs.[2]

2. **Fabian acknowledges and prepares the sandbox.** This is a preview copy with a yellow banner, not the live site. Its link has the form https://forabrighterevanston.org/sandbox/<id>/ . Only one sandbox can be open at a time; further requests join the existing update.[2]

3. **Review the sandbox and request edits.** Anyone in #website can contribute, not just the original requester. Nothing in the sandbox is published to the live site merely because it looks finished.[2]

4. **Review both languages when available.** Spanish is encouraged but not mandatory for website updates. Fabian should offer a translation when English content changes without Spanish.[2]

The sandbox stays open until the group publishes or destroys it; inactivity alone does not close it. News remains managed through #news, and the sandbox is intended to show the current live news list.[2]

What you can request

Site icon: the small emblem in browser tabs and Google results is shared across the website, including both languages. It is separate from each page's sharing card. Google controls when its search results refresh and does not guarantee that an icon appears; a Search Console owner can request a homepage recrawl.[2]

- New pages and changes to ordinary page content.[2]
- Every new page includes its own sharing card: a relevant image, page-specific title and short description. Fabian prepares these with the page and shows them in the preview review. English and Spanish versions get matching copy and, when the artwork has text, matching images. The team vote covers the page and card together; existing pages are not changed automatically.[2]
- New or updated templates: the shared building blocks that arrange page sections, headers, menus and footers. These need **no extra permission from German**. They follow the same sandbox, review and team vote as other website updates.[2]

- Supported text changes on built-in pages, such as home-page wording, next-meeting information and news-page labels.[2]
- Images in JPG, PNG, WebP or GIF format, and PDF documents up to 5 MB. Fabian should resize photos and strip location metadata before adding them.[2]

Narrow sandbox-only approvals: German or Kerstin Shamberg can explicitly approve page-specific styling for named pages/languages, or hosting a supplied, unchanged, macro-free Excel (`.xlsx`) financial model in the preview. Say which pages/languages or exact model you mean. Kerstin can approve future requests of these same kinds, but each needs its own explicit scope; an uploaded design or workbook is not approval. Fabian verifies the supplied model's unchanged bytes and safety without running its contents. This is not a global redesign permission or a direct-publication permission: copy/source checks, pending-resource holds, review and the team vote still apply.[2]

Process maintenance is separate: Kerstin's styling/model delegation does not let her approve changes to Fabian's rules, manuals or validation tools. German's original delegation-maintenance approval and his separate approval-check repair for the existing two-page copy-link feature are distinct, narrowly bound permissions. Fabian verifies the original human messages and exact reviewed files independently, uses the correct record for each, and does not treat an urgency message as permission. Other maintenance still needs German's own explicit approval. Neither permission approves campaign wording, releases a copy/resource hold or bypasses the normal review and vote.[2]

Copy link on the poll page: On the English voter-poll page and its Spanish counterpart, "Copy link" / "Copiar enlace" copies that page's current URL; a fallback is available when the browser's normal clipboard action is denied. German's permission covers only the existing reviewed script and its loading on these two pages. It is not blanket JavaScript permission, is not delegated to Kerstin, and does not authorize publication. Fabian tests the actual action in both languages and checks the exact script against its separate approval record.[2]

Approval example — only German or Kerstin can grant it:

> @fabian I approve page-specific styling for Home, The Poll and A Brighter Path Forward, in English and Spanish, and hosting the supplied macro-free Excel financial model in [sandbox name] for review only. Do not publish yet.

Changes that still need German's separate authorization: other stylesheet changes, executable scripts, site/build settings, unsafe forms or embeds, macros, and deleting published pages or existing templates. Adding or updating a template—including moving homepage sections or changing a shared menu—is part of the normal team workflow, not an exception. Shared changes must be checked on all affected pages, in English and Spanish and on phones and desktops, before voting. The Write to the Board letter text is still outside this workflow because it lives in a script.[2]

Useful follow-ups in #website

> @fabian What has changed in the sandbox?
>
> @fabian Replace the second paragraph on [page] with: [exact text]
>
> @fabian Add the Spanish version too.
>
> @fabian Undo the last change.

Build or update a page from a mockup

A mockup is a file showing what a page should look like, such as an HTML page, an image or a PDF.

Example request in #website

> @fabian Please build a new rally page from the attached mockup.

1. **Say it's a mockup.** Fabian never assumes a shared file is a mockup. If your message doesn't say so, he asks whether to build from it, add it to the page as it is, or keep it just for reference.[2]

2. **Agree what matters.** Fabian lists what he sees: the text, the layout, the style, the pictures, the links and buttons, and the Spanish. He says how he'll use each one. By default he follows the layout with the site's own style; pictures are used only if you confirm they're final and send the original files. Tell him what to change.[2]

3. **Fill in what's missing.** Fabian lists every gap in the mockup in one message, for example `[day of the event]`, “TBD”, sample text or a button with no destination. He never fills a gap by guessing or from other pages. He may suggest an answer, but uses it only if you say yes. The update can't go to a vote until every gap is filled.[2]

4. **The text is copied exactly.** Every word, number, capital letter and punctuation mark from the mockup appears on the page as written. Fabian doesn't fix typos on his own; he asks you. Text the site needs that the mockup doesn't have, such as the page's description for search results, is labeled as written by Fabian so you can change it. A checking tool confirms the page matches the mockup before you see the preview.[2]

5. **Review and vote as usual.** The preview, Spanish offer, sharing card, review and team vote work the same as for any other update.[2]

Tips: send the original file rather than a screenshot of it. Mark anything not final with brackets, like `[photo of the rally]`. If the mockup has its own menu or footer, that's ignored unless you ask for a menu change.

3. Review, vote and publish website changes

Request publication

When the sandbox is ready, post: **“@fabian Publish [sandbox name]”** or **“@fabian Let’s vote on [sandbox name].”** This requests a review and vote; it does not bypass either step.[2]

Fabian brings the sandbox up to date, checks permitted changes, links, images and language coverage, and checks desktop and phone layouts. The review lists changes, blocking problems, suggestions, Spanish status, visual findings and Fabian’s recommendation. If a visual check cannot be completed, that limitation must be disclosed. Blocking problems must be fixed before voting.[2]

Fabian also owns the page-organization check before every vote. He checks clear page titles and headings, understandable navigation and link labels, working links between important pages, and English/Spanish connections. He keeps the sitemap—the page list supplied to search engines—synchronized as pages change, and checks the live list after publication. Missing important links or an incorrect page list must be fixed before voting. This helps Google understand the site but does not guarantee that Google displays subpage shortcuts.[2]

For a new page, review its sharing image, title and description too. These are what the page supplies when someone shares its link. Fabian checks them before and after publication; an app may still show an older cached preview.[2]

Sharing cards can also be updated for existing pages without changing their on-page headlines or text. Fabian should use the approved designs and wording, preserve the rest of the site, and check every affected language version.[2]

Cast your vote

For a reliable mention, type @fabian and select Fabian from Slack's suggestions, then add your vote and send it as a new channel message. If acknowledgment is missing, ask Fabian to check the original vote and tally rather than repeatedly sending yes. Seeing a message, counting a vote and publishing the site are different steps; Fabian should say clearly which has happened.

Fabian's vote message includes a link to the updated site, a direct link to every changed page, and a short summary of each change, so anyone can review before voting.[2]

- **Vote by posting a message in #website:** "@fabian vote yes" or "@fabian vote no: [your reason]". Reactions do not count; votes must be messages mentioning @fabian.[2]
- Short forms work too: "@fabian yes", "@fabian ✓", "@fabian no, [reason]". To take a vote back: "@fabian withdraw my vote". If your message is unclear, Fabian asks whether it's a yes or a no.[2]
- Everyone in #website can vote, including the requester. Each person counts once, using their latest vote; bots do not count. Fabian replies to every vote with the running tally.[2]
- The update passes as soon as there are **two or more yes votes and zero no votes**. Any no vote blocks publication while it remains; please explain the concern so the group can address it.[2]
- The vote is open for **24 hours** from Fabian's vote message. If it expires without passing, the sandbox remains, but publication needs a fresh review and vote.[2]
- The sandbox is **frozen during voting**. To change it, say "@fabian Cancel the vote on [sandbox name]," then request edits. A new review and vote are required afterward.[2]

Fabian recounts from the channel on every vote message, so a vote is never lost or counted twice. Votes after the 24-hour deadline don't count. Fabian posts the closing message at the deadline if a scheduled check is set up, otherwise the next time anyone mentions him in #website. He doesn't promise reminders he can't schedule. The vote applies only to the reviewed version: if the sandbox changes, the old approvals cannot authorize publication of the new version.[2]

After approval

Fabian publishes the approved update without changing the news list, verifies the changed live pages, removes the sandbox and posts the live links and approvers. A failed build or merge conflict must be reported—not described as a successful publication.[2]

After a website update is fully live

Fabian finishes live-page verification, preview cleanup, durable records and the top-level completion message before running Hermes `/compact` (Slack equivalent: `!compact`) as the final closeout step. This does not run after a preview edit or while publication is pending. Compaction summarizes conversation context; it does not replace publication records or start a new conversation. If the interface cannot invoke the command, Fabian records it as pending and tells German privately instead of claiming success. This rule does not itself install an automatic runtime hook.[2]

Restart, destroy or roll back

- **Restart:** "@fabian Restart [sandbox name]." Discards sandbox changes and returns it to the current live version, while keeping a sandbox available.[2]
- **Destroy:** "@fabian Destroy [sandbox name]." Removes the sandbox and its changes; the live site is not changed.[2]

- **Confirmation:** Both actions require Fabian to describe what will be lost and obtain a “yes” in #website. Anyone in that channel may confirm. Either action also cancels an active vote.[2]
- **Roll back a published update:** Contact German. Only German can request a rollback through his DM with Fabian, and he must confirm the particular update before it is undone.[2]

4. Progress, problems and useful links

What to expect from Fabian

Fabian should acknowledge before starting, mention the requester, use top-level messages, and keep an editable status message current. During long waits, there should be an update at least once a minute. A separate final message confirms the actual result.[1][2]

- **[Eyes]** Request seen / work started.[1][2]
- **[Hourglass]** Work or publication in progress.[1][2]
- ✓ The relevant task is complete; for publication, the live result has been checked.[1][2]
- **[Warning]** A problem or a question needing an answer; while awaiting a preview confirmation, [Eyes] may also remain.[1]

Reactions and progress messages never substitute for an article confirmation or a website vote; website votes are messages to @fabian.[1][2]

If something goes wrong

- **No acknowledgment:** Mention @fabian in the correct channel and ask German to check access if there is still no response. A Slack API connection working does not by itself mean every team member’s messages are authorized. Do not share tokens or passwords in the channel. This is an operational troubleshooting recommendation.
- **Preview is wrong:** Request corrections before confirming. For news, approve the revised preview—not an earlier version.[1]
- **Changes are not visible:** Wait for the completion message, then refresh. News builds usually take 1–2 minutes and sandbox builds about 2–3 minutes, but these are estimates; news caching can last up to ten minutes. If a build is still missing after ten minutes, ask Fabian to check its status.[1][2]
- **Conflicting edits, failed builds or permission problems:** Fabian should explain the blocker and involve German where required rather than silently continuing.[1][2]

Useful links

- Live website: https://forabrighterevanston.org/
- English news: https://forabrighterevanston.org/home/in-the-news/
- Spanish news: https://forabrighterevanston.org/es/noticias/

Administrator readiness checklist

Before relying on the workflow for the whole team, verify that the intended requesters are authorized, Fabian receives messages in both channels, and the sandbox builds and voting checks operate as documented. GitHub Pages must use **GitHub Actions** as its build/deployment source for the sandbox workflow; merging the files alone does not establish that setup is complete.[2]

This guide does not change Slack access, deployment settings or the website. Changes to Fabian’s user-facing functionality require a review of this guide and a regenerated PDF in the same update.

Sources

[1] https://github.com/germanespinosa/for-a-brighter-evanston/blob/main/docs/agents/fabian-news.md

[2] https://github.com/germanespinosa/for-a-brighter-evanston/blob/main/docs/agents/fabian-website.md